

Course Evaluation Survey Learning Activity

STA304 — Summer 2026

Learning Activity 1 Overview

In this activity you will critically analyze an actual student course evaluation survey administered at the University of Toronto for STA304 in Fall 2023. The response rate for this survey was 51 out of 229 invited participants.

Part 1: Course Evaluation Survey

The following is a reproduction of the University of Toronto's course evaluation survey.

Section 1: Core Institutional Items

Scale: 1 = Not At All 2 = Somewhat 3 = Moderately 4 = Mostly 5 = A Great Deal

1. I found the course intellectually stimulating.
2. The course provided me with a deeper understanding of the subject matter.
3. The instructor created an atmosphere that was conducive to my learning.
4. Course projects, assignments, tests, and/or exams improved my understanding of the course material.
5. Course projects, assignments, tests and/or exams provided opportunity for me to demonstrate an understanding of the course material.

Scale: 1 = Poor 2 = Fair 3 = Good 4 = Very Good 5 = Excellent

6. Overall, the quality of my learning experience in this course was:

Section 2: Divisional Items

Scale: 1 = Not At All 2 = Somewhat 3 = Moderately 4 = Mostly 5 = A Great Deal

7. The instructor generated enthusiasm for learning in the course.

Scale: 1 = Very Light 2 = Light 3 = Average 4 = Heavy 5 = Very Heavy

8. Compared to other courses, the workload for this course was...

Scale: 1 = Not At All 2 = Somewhat 3 = Moderately 4 = Mostly 5 = Strongly

9. I would recommend this course to other students.

Section 3: Departmental Items

Scale: 1 = Poor 2 = Fair 3 = Good 4 = Very Good 5 = Excellent

10. Overall, the quality of instruction provided by the instructor in this course was:

Section 4: Open-Ended Questions

11. Please comment on the overall quality of the instruction in this course.
12. Please comment on any assistance that was available to support your learning in this course.

Part 2: Learning Activity Questions

Answer all questions thoroughly. Support your arguments with reasoning from course concepts where applicable.

1. Identify the target population, sampling unit, and observation unit, and propose a reasonable sampling frame.
2. Visit the Information for Students webpage <https://teaching.utoronto.ca/course-evaluations/for-students/>. What procedure is used to distribute and collect the surveys? What are some possible sources of selection bias? Do you think selection bias is likely to have occurred in this context? Briefly justify your answer.
3. Evaluate each of the following survey questions using the questionnaire design principles discussed in class. For each question, identify any problems it may exhibit (e.g., leading wording, double-barreled structure, or vague language). State the concept of interest, and rewrite the question to better measure that concept.
 - Question 3
 - Question 4
4. Rewrite Question 12 as a leading question and explain why your revised version is considered leading.
5. Suggest and briefly explain some ways this survey was designed and administered to reduce measurement error or measurement bias.
6. Explain why you think student evaluations do, or do not, give an accurate measurement of student satisfaction with the course.